

# Plaster, Drywall and Trim

The naming half of this topic. Every one of these is a definition question, and a definition question always wants the term.

|                                            |                                                                                                                              |
|--------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Lath                                       | A metal, gypsum or wood material applied to interior walls or ceilings to serve as a base for plaster.                       |
| Basecoat                                   | The first layer or layers of plaster applied over lath or other substrate.                                                   |
| Key                                        | The grip or mechanical bond of one coat of plaster to another coat or to a plaster base.                                     |
| Furring                                    | The means of supporting a finished surfacing material away from the structural wall or framing.                              |
| Backup strips or nailers                   | Used at corners to provide fastening for the ends of plaster base or gypsum panels.                                          |
| Gypsum board                               |                                                                                                                              |
| Tapered edge                               | An edge formation of gypsum board that provides a shallow depression at the paper-bound edge to receive joint reinforcement. |
| Metal corner bead                          | What protects an outside corner in plaster, stucco or sheetrock.                                                             |
| Type W bugle head screws                   | 1 1/4 inch, for attaching one layer of 5/8 gypsum board to wood studs. W is for wood.                                        |
| Glass mat or fiber-cement substrate sheets | The product used as a base for wall tile at tub or shower areas. Ordinary paper-faced gypsum fails in a wet location.        |

|                                     |                          |
|-------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| The numbers here                    |                          |
| Drywall screw — one layer           | 1 1/4 in                 |
| Metal corner bead fastening pattern | 9 in on center, opposite |

## Trim

|                   |                                                                                                                                                                           |
|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Miter             | A joint formed by two pieces of material cut to meet at an angle.                                                                                                         |
| Base-shoe         | The small molding covering the gap between the baseboard and the finished floor. It is nailed to the baseboard, not to the floor, so the floor underneath can still move. |
| Finger-joint trim | Interior wood trim suitable for painting but not for staining — the joints would show straight through a clear finish.                                                    |

## Say it back

Cover the page. Answer each one out loud.

1. Lath, basecoat and key — say what each one is.
2. What is furring, and what are backup strips for?
3. What is a tapered edge for, and what protects an outside corner?
4. Which screw attaches 5/8 gypsum to wood studs, and what does the W mean?
5. What goes behind wall tile at a shower, and why not ordinary gypsum?
6. What is a miter, and what is base-shoe nailed to?
7. Which trim takes paint but not stain?